MACPAC CONTROL 90

October 6th/7th - Okiwi Bay, Nelson/Marlborough

The MACPAC Control 90 is the first multi sport rogaine to be held in NZ. Nathan Fa'avae and Mark Rayward of adventure Mission Events are running the inaugural event.

The MACPAC Control 90 is an original concept and consists of 3 rogaines, each 4 hours. They will be kayak, hike and mountain bike. On each section there will be 30 controls. The course is not designed to be impossible. For a fast team with faultless navigation, it is possible to get all the controls. Although unlikely, should more than one team get all 90 controls, it will be the team (2 or 4 person) with the fastest time that will win.

The event in some ways is very similar to a 12-hour adventure race. The difference is that it is not non-stop. There will be a 2-hour break between each leg. During legs 2 & 3 dinner will be supplied, which will include a wild pig roasted on a spit. Between each leg there will be coffee, drinks and snacks available.

Another difference is that in an adventure race the slower teams often take twice as long as the winning team. At the Control 90, all teams will effectively be out there for 12 hours total, and finish each leg within minutes of each other. The very social teams though may only choose to spend 2-3 hours on each leg and have bigger breaks between.

Another difference between the Control 90 and an Adventure Race is teams do not need a support crew. All 3 rogaines will start and finish at the Okiwi Bay Motor Camp (yes! Hot showers).

Okiwi Bay was chosen as the venue because of its idyllic beauty and awesome adventure activities. (1 hour from Nelson, Picton and Blenheim). The kayak rogaine will be held in Croiselles Harbour, which has over 40 square kilometres of sheltered waterway. There are numerous islands, sea caves and hundreds of bays, coves and beaches as well as some other unique coastal features, such as a huge boulder field the tide has created.

The mountain biking in the Okiwi Bay area is mainly in forestry with exciting downhills, steep climbs and spectacular views. The hiking rogaine is a mixture of native forest and coastal travel.

During each leg, there will also be 3 special tests. These will be novelty challenges that will be fun and humorous, but also give teams who may not have loads of horsepower to earn points. Brain versus brawn. There is even a prize and points bonus for the team who catches the biggest fish during the kayak rogaine.

The course setter is Mark Rayward. He is a former Outward Bound Instructor and Army Adventure Trainer. He has regularly competed in the Heights of Winter, Twalk and the Southern Traverse.

Event promoter Nathan Fa'avae says, "The Macpac Control 90 is the bridge between a social weekend mission and an event. We are working hard to make it as social and eventful as possible, while still retaining the element of competition for those that want it. It will be a circus".

The event has a great list of sponsors that can be viewed at: http://www.missionevents.co.nz

Email nathan@missionevents.co.nz if you want an entry form posted to you.